ZHIHAN LIU

PRODUCT DESIGNER | PRODUCT UX · AI-ASSISTED INTERACTION DESIGN

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ABOUT ME

Product designer with an MFA in Design and Technology, experienced in consumer fintech, staff tools, and customer-facing apps. I translate complex product needs into clear workflows, interfaces, and testable prototypes. I work with founders and engineers on design systems, Figma handoff specifications, and implementation tradeoffs, then iterate from user feedback.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Co-Founder & Chief Designer
Hong Kong
Crystal Citizen
2023 – 2025

- Co-founded and led product and brand design for an independent lifestyle figurine line, translating market research into concepts, 3D prototypes, packaging, and production-ready designs in coordination with manufacturers.
- Designed UI components and shipped the brand's Shopify e-commerce site, carrying the visual identity from physical products and packaging into the online shopping experience.

Freelance Social Media Content Creator & Product Designer
New York, NY
Seven Sense
Oct 2024 – Present

- Design UI/UX and feature functionality for an internal and external-facing app product, supporting both staff operations and customer-facing experiences, collaborating with the development team in an agile workflow.
- Build a design system and UI components for the app and prepare Figma handoff specifications. Work directly with the engineering team to discuss design intent, technical constraints, and implementation tradeoffs across the app's staff and customer workflows.

Product Designer
New York, NY
Awesome Bears (Remote)
2026 – Present

- Own product design for TraderBear, a shipped consumer fintech product used by live customers; work directly with the CEO, co-founder, and marketing lead to shape product direction and design decisions.
- Design AI-powered community mechanics that make trading and financial concepts more approachable for mainstream, non-expert users, translating complex financial behavior into simple, low-friction interactions.
- Lead localization design for the mobile app in parallel with core product design work, adapting the experience for new markets.

Lead Game Narrative Designer
Beijing, China
Sohu.com (Game) Ltd.
Feb 2021 – Feb 2023

- Led narrative design for Rakshasa Street, a commercially launched mobile RPG, from concept through release. Designed chapter architecture, character story systems, onboarding flows, and tutorial scripts in close collaboration with art, engineering, and production leads.
- Reported directly to the CEO as a cross-project design resource, using market and player research to identify concepts for incubation and prioritize ideas across product teams. Validated concepts through large-scale playtests, using qualitative and quantitative player feedback to inform design decisions.
- Analyzed player drop-off data to identify friction in tutorials and pacing; used findings to iterate chapter structure and game systems.
- Created a cross-department production tracking system aligning narrative, art, and systems design deliverables by chapter. Gave downstream teams a shared reference for weekly outputs, supporting cross-team coordination and clear handoffs throughout production.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Gamified Community Web App *Bad Children Shop*
Present
Independent Product Design · In Development

- Sole designer and builder of a community web app, collaborating with an entertainment company's community operations team. Designed the product in Figma and built a working prototype with Codex, connecting offline participation with digital identities and community features.
- Tested with 30+ early participants using remote self-guided sessions, questionnaires, and an in-person group. Found that the capsule interaction obscured deeper features and iterated the experience loops based on user feedback.
- Built keyboard access, a direct-open alternative, reduced-motion support, and touch/mouse interactions; continue iterating the prototype before wider release.

EDUCATION

Parsons School of Design New York, NY
MFA, Design and Technology
Aug 2024 – May 2026
physical-digital interaction · hardware prototyping · creative coding · product design

Beijing Film Academy Beijing, China
BFA, Film and Television Literature
Aug 2017 – Jun 2021
screenwriting · storyboarding · film planning · narrative theory · animation

SKILLS

A. Product & UX Design
· Figma
· Wireframing & Interactive Prototyping
· Design Systems & UI Components
· Figma Handoff Specifications
· Usability Testing & User Feedback
· Interaction & Workflow Design
· Cross-functional Collaboration

B. AI-Assisted Design & Development
· Codex
· Claude Code
· AI-Assisted Workflows

C. Web & Creative Technology
· HTML & CSS
· JavaScript
· p5.js
· Front-end Feasibility
· AR / VR Interaction
· Creative Coding
· Arduino
· Unity 3D
· Touch Designer

D. Brand & Visual Design
· Brand Identity
· Packaging Design
· Visual Storytelling
· Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign)
· Motion & Video (Premiere, After Effects, 2D Animation)

E. Physical & Spatial Design
· 3D Modeling & Physical Prototyping (Blender, 3D Print)
· Exhibition Design
· Physical Production

Languages
· English (professional)
· Chinese / Mandarin (native)